

REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA
CHIRUNDU TOWN COUNCIL

Chirundu Town Council Citizen Engagement Strategy



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1. Introduction

1.1 Background

Citizen Engagement (CE) is a vital element of democratic governance and sustainable development. In Zambia, Citizen Engagement is firmly grounded in national laws and policies, including the Constitution, the 2023 Decentralization Policy, the 2019 Local Government Act, and the 2020 National Planning and Budgeting Act. These instruments promote inclusive, transparent, and accountable local government operations. Through mechanisms such as Output-Based Budgeting (OBB) and Public Investment Management (PIM), citizen engagements enables community members to play an active role in identifying development priorities, tracking project progress, and ensuring accountability from public officials. This strategy offers a clear framework for Chirundu Town Council to strengthen its citizen engagement efforts across governance, budgeting, and project management. Its goal is to empower communities, enhance decision-making, and build greater trust between the council and its residents.

1.2 Current Citizen Engagement. Efforts by Chirundu Council

Chirundu Town Council has initiated Citizens Engagement through Ward Development Committees (WDCs), community consultations, community engagements and budget hearings. While these have created important platforms for dialogue, several gaps remain:

Strengths: Establishment of WDCs, periodic budget consultations, inclusion of community leaders, private sector, Faith based organizations, Civil Society

Weaknesses: Limited citizen feedback after budget approval, weak grievance redress mechanisms, inadequate documentation, and partial inclusion of marginalized groups such as women, youth, and persons with disabilities.

This Citizen Engagement Strategy (CES) will bridge these gaps by institutionalizing inclusive, transparent, and continuous engagement practices across the OBB and PIM cycles.



2. Vision, Aim and Objectives

2.1 Vision

A top notch investment destination by 2034

2.2. Aim

To strengthen the efficiency and social economic transformation for improved livelihoods through sustainable development of Chirundu District.

2.3 Objectives

1. To become an industrialized and diversified district to 100% by 2034
2. Enhanced Citizenry Participation in the Economy by 2034
3. Increase in Revenue Mobilization by 25% within 5 years

3. Approaches and Methods of Engagement

The Chirundu District Council will employ a variety of initiatives to ensure inclusive citizen engagement, recognizing the diversity of the community and ensuring meaningful two-way communication between citizens and civic leaders. Engagement will be ongoing and tailored to different stages of the budget and project cycle. Methods include:

A. Citizen Participation in Key Decision-Making and Keeping Citizens Informed

1. Service Delivery Charters to set standards for council commitments and expectations.
2. Physical public meetings, including full council meetings, stakeholder engagement meetings, zonal meetings, and community forums, held in central, accessible, and neutral venues.
3. Workshops on key projects or policies, led by civil society organizations (CSOs) or other stakeholders, to provide structured and informed consultation with WDCs.

B. Citizen Monitoring of Budget and Project Implementation

1. Reporting progress to citizens via community radio programs, notice boards, megaphones, and social media updates.
2. Inclusion of selected stakeholders in monitoring visits to projects, promoting transparency and accountability.

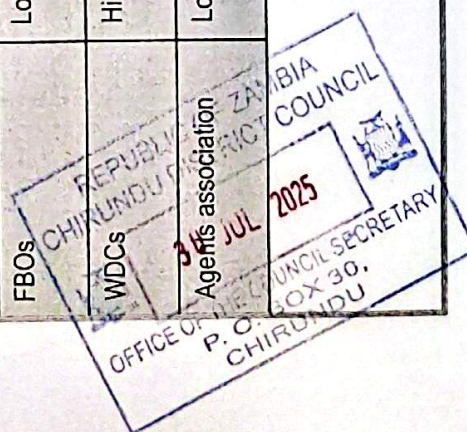


STAKEHOLDER ASSESSMENT MATRIX

C- Current Level of engagement

D – Desired Level of engagement

STAKEHOLDERS	POWER/INTEREST	UNAWARE	RESISTANT	NEUTRAL	SUPPORTIVE	LEADING
Traditional Leaders	High/High				C	D
Community Members	Low/High			C	D	
Traders	Low/High			C	D	
Motorist	Low/High			C	D	
CSOs	Low/High			C	D	
FBOs	Low/ High			C	D	
WDCs	High/High				C	D
Agents association	Low/High			C	D	



Business association	Low/High			C	D	
District Commissioner	High/High				C	D
ZEMA	High/low		C		D	
Councillors	High/high				C	D

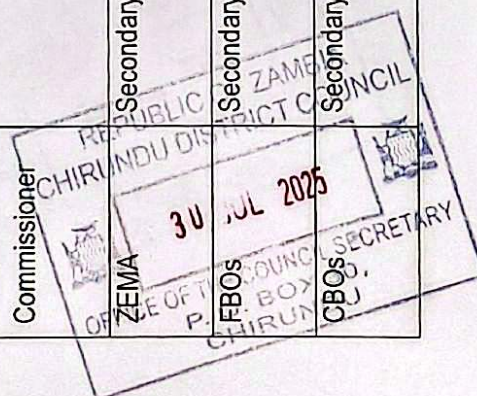


STAKEHOLDER ENGAGEMENT PLAN

Stakeholder	Classification	Interest/Power	Involvement Decision	Current Engagement Level	Desired Engagement Level	Engagement Strategy	Engagement Goal	Engagement Method
Traditional leaders	Primary	High/high	high	Supportive	Supportive	hold stakeholder meeting prior and after to the project implementation	Increased awareness by headmen	Round table meeting
Community Members	Primary	High/low	low	Neutral	Supportive	Community sensitizations	Ensure that at least 50% of participants in community discussions are from underrepresented groups, such as women, youth, and elderly members, by the end of the first phase of the project.	Public announcements Community meetings



Councillors	Tertiary	High/High	High	Supportive	Leading	Hold stakeholder meetings monthly Spot checks	All councillors updated with the status of the project phases	Round table meeting
District Commissioner	Tertiary	High/high	High	Supportive	Leading	Meetings/ spot checks	Continuous updates on the project	Round table meeting
ZEMA	Secondary	Low/high	low	Unaware	Supportive	Meeting and site inspections	Compliance checks	Online submission
FBOs	Secondary	Low/high	low	Neutral	Supportive	Community sensitizations	At least 10% representation	Community meetings
CBOs	Secondary	Low/ High	low	Neutral	supportive	Community sensitizations	At 10% representation	Community meetings



WDCs	Primary	High/High	High	Supportive	Leading	Stakeholder holder meetings	Increased awareness by all WDCs	Community Meetings
Agents Associations	Secondary	Low/High	Low	Neutral	Supportive	Community meetings	At least 10% representation	Community meetings
Business Associations	Secondary	Low/High	Low	Neutral	Supportive	Community meetings	At least 10% representation	Community meetings



4. Implementation Plan

This plan provides a structured approach to ensure effective participation of all stakeholders in the budgeting process and other council development activities. The plan will focus on assessing current practices, identifying engagement opportunities, and mapping out key stakeholders with clear timelines and responsibilities.

Assessment of Current Citizen Engagement

The Council currently engages citizen mainly during budget preparation, project identification, and process changes; this is done through face-to-face meetings, and radio programs.

Stakeholder Engagement, Opportunities, Timelines and Responsibilities

This Implementation Plan serves as a practical roadmap for putting the Citizen Engagement Strategy (CES) into action throughout the year. It highlights key opportunities for stakeholder involvement, specifies timelines for engagement activities, and defines the roles and responsibilities of all relevant actors, including Council staff, WDCs, CSOs, and community representatives. The plan ensures that participation is organized, inclusive, and impactful, allowing citizens to contribute meaningfully to the budgeting process and other Council programs.

To carry out this approach, the Council has outlined stakeholder engagement points, corresponding timelines, and assigned responsibilities in the table below, ensuring that every stakeholder is informed, engaged, and able to contribute at the right stages of the budget and project cycles.

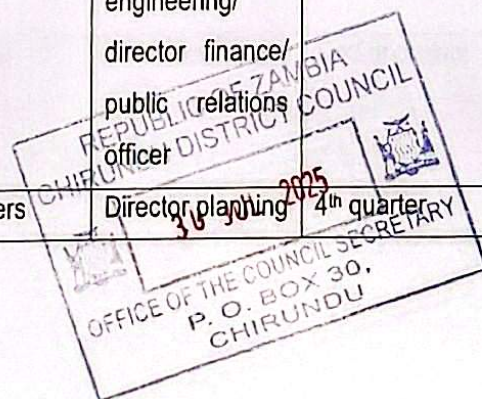
Beyond the budget cycle, citizen participation will also be deliberately embedded in the Public Investment Management (PIM) process. Citizens will be engaged at critical stages, including project identification, proposal development, appraisal and selection, monitoring during execution, providing feedback for adjustments, and evaluating completed projects.

Table 1: Proposed Stakeholder Engagement Plan Summary Table

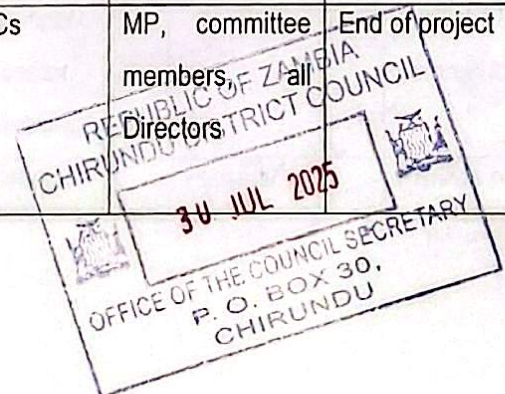
BUDGET STAGE	KEY FEATURES/ACTIVITIES	STAKEHOLDER CATEGORY INVOLVED	RESPONSIBLE OFFICER	TIMELINE
Preparation for budget formulation/ planning	i. Provide communities with Stakeholder Engagement Plan (SEP) giving proposed dates for consultation ii. Provide WDCs with a list of	Councillors WDCs	Director Planning/ Director Engineering	3 rd quarter



	proposed projects for consideration in this budget cycle as well as a list of ongoing projects and completed projects for the past 2 years.			
iii.	Using the project lists provided, communities may accept or reject project proposals and make their own proposals for development projects and activities for their Wards to be included in the budget based on their priorities	Councillors WDCs, General public	Director planning	3 rd quarter
iv.	Produce a summarized stakeholder report from all Wards and submit report to MLGRD.	General public	Council secretary/ Director planning	3 rd quarter
v.	Conduct budget hearings & Town Hall meetings.	General public	Public relations officer	4 th quarter
vi.	The Town Clerk/Council Secretary shall present the reports to the full council.	General public	Council secretary	4 th quarter
vii.	Feedback meetings to WDCs on what projects and activities have been included in the budget	General public	Director planning/director engineering/ director finance/ public relations officer	4 th quarter
viii.	Reports including minutes	Committee members	Director planning	4 th quarter



	must be submitted to the PLGOs office for review and consolidation for onward submission to MLGRD.			
	ix. MLGRD will submit the consolidated reports to MoFNP.	Chirundu town council	PLGO	4 th quarter
Budget approval (public awareness of budget details)	i. Review the proposed budget and assess whether input from community, especially vulnerable groups i.e. women, PWDs and children had been incorporated.	General public	Director planning/Director finance/ public relations officer	1 st quarter
	ii. Feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders of the final approved budget	Councillors/WDCs	Public relations officer	1 st quarter
Budget execution and monitoring (for transparency in budget implementation)	i. Track the effective utilisation of funds in line with planned activities.	Committee members/ WDCs/ MP/ general public	Director of finance/ director planning/ director engineering	Throughout implementation process
	ii. Report back on a regular basis to WDCs on implementation of activities and projects	Councillors/ WDCs	Public relations officer	2 nd -3 rd quarter
Budget evaluation and Review	i. Evaluate the impact of allocated funds, focusing on agreed upon programmes with a bias	Councillors/ WDCs	MP, committee members, all Directors	End of project

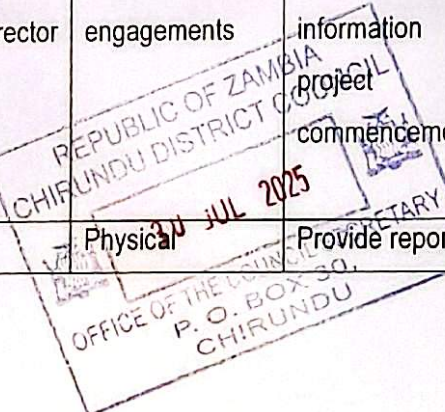


	towards gender, persons with disabilities, child-related and climate change outcomes.			
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5. Communication Plan

Table 2: Communication Plan Summary

DELIVERABLE/ ACTIVITY	TARGET STAKEHOLDERS	FREQUENCY	PROPOSED TIMELINE/ DATE	RESPONSIBILITY	COMMUNICATION METHOD	COMMENTS
Budget Consultation Meetings	General public	Before the budget formulation	September (with notices sent 7 days prior)	Public relations officer/ director finance	Radio announcements, physical engagements, public notices	Capture community priorities for inclusion in the budget.
Dissemination of Draft Budget	General public	Before budget hearing	4 th quarter	Public relations officer/ director finance/ engineering/ planning	Physical engagement, digital platforms	Ensure transparency and inclusivity before budget approval
Feedback Meetings on Approved Budget	General public	After budget approval	1 st quarter	Public relations officer	Radio announcements, physical engagements, public notices	feedback on what projects were included/ excluded
Project implementation	WDCs/ Councilors	After budget approval	1 st quarter	Public relations officer/ director finance/ director planning	Physical engagements	Provide information of project commencement
Monitoring and	WDCs/	During project	Quarterly	Director	Physical	Provide reports



progress updates	councilors	implemenation	(project cycle)	engineering/ planning and public relations officer	engagements	
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6. Budget (for the Implementation of the CE Process)

ensure the successful execution of the citizen engagement strategy (CES), the Council has allocated specific budget lines to support a planned activities. This budget covers costs related to stakeholder consultations, workshops, communication and publicity, monitoring and evaluation. Proper budgeting ensures that engagement activities are systematic, sustainable, and effectively resourced, enabling meaningful participation and accountability throughout the budget and project cycles.

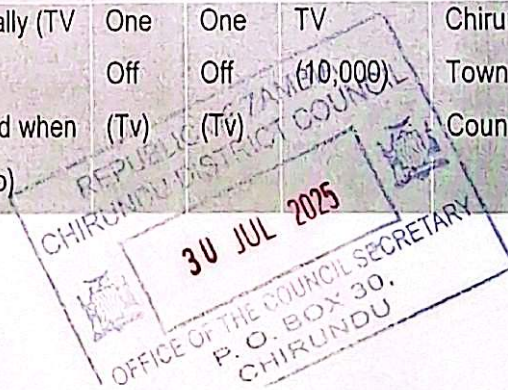
Objective	Measure	Activity	Indicator	Frequency	Annual Targets		Estimated Cost (K)	Responsible Institution
					2025	2026		

RADIO AND TV PROGRAMMES

Enhance public awareness	Enhance targeted awareness campaigns through various media	1. Air recorded radio programmes in Tonga	Number of recorded radio programmes aired in Tonga language	Quarterly	4	4	6,000	Chirundu Town Council
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2. Conduct live radio programmes in Tonga	Number of live radio programmes conducted in Tonga language	Weekly	48	48	144,000	Chirundu Town Council
3. TV programmes to disseminate information to the community	Number of TV program aired	As and when	1	1	29,904	Chirundu Town Council
4. Production of Jingles in Local Language	Number of Jingles produced in Tonga language	Bi-Annual	2	2	5,000	Chirundu Town Council
5. Airing of Bemba jingles	Number of Jingles aired in Local Language	21 Times a Year/ Twice daily (to run on a 7 Day plan- concurrently)	21	21	21,840	Chirundu Town Council
6. Production of advertisement	Number of adverts produced	Twice a year	2	2	800	Chirundu Town Council
7. Airing of advertisements.	Number of advertisement aired	Annually (TV As and when (Radio)	One Off (Tv)	One Off (Tv)	TV (10,000)	Chirundu Town Council

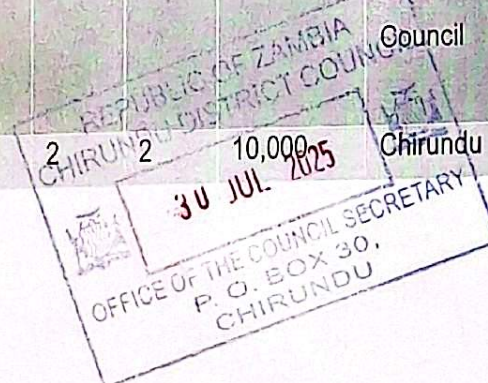


			Radio (14)	Radio (14)	Radio (20,000)	
8. Production of Documentaries in English and Tonga	Number of documentaries produced in English and local language	Annually	1	1	260,000	Chirundu Town Council

Develop tailored information packs for dissemination of necessary information to the general public

DEVELOPMENT OF SBC/IEC MATERIALS

		Quarterly	4	4	0.0	Chirundu Town Council
9. Development of SBC materials	Number of SBC material development meeting					
10. Printing and distribution of brochures	Number of brochures printed and distributed	Quarterly	600	600	20,000	Chirundu Town Council
11. Printing and Distribution of posters	Number of posters printed and distributed	32	16	16	2,000	Chirundu Town Council
12. Printing and distribution tear drops	Number of tear drops printed and distributed	4	2	2	10,000	Chirundu Town Council
13. Printing and	Number of pop	4	2	2	10,000	Chirundu



Distribution of Pop up stands	ups stands printed and distributed						Town Council
14. Printing and distributions of back drops	Number of back drops printed and distributed	2	1	1	15,000		Chirundu Town Council
15. Branding of Projects- infrastructure	Number of Branded Projects- infrastructure	As and When	TBA	0	100, 000		Chirundu Town Council
16. Printing and distribution of banners	Number of Banners Printed and Distributed	6	3	3	9,000		Chirundu Town Council
17. Printing and Distribution of flyers	Number of fliers printed and distributed	4000	2000	2000	20,000		Chirundu Town Council
18. Produce Social media content	Number of posts	2 posts per week	96	96	2,000		Chirundu Town Council
	% age growth of people reached	2 posts per week	40%	65%	0.0		Chirundu Town Council
USE SOCIAL PLATFORM							
19. Facebook	No. Of Messages	2 post Per week and	96	96	2,000		Chirundu Town Council



	posted	boosting					Council
20. Website	No. Of Messages posted	1 post per week	48	48	0		Chirundu Town Council

21. Whatsapp	No. Of Messages posted	1 post weekly	48	48	0		Chirundu Town Council (for PRO)
	No. Of Gadgets mobile phones procured	1	0	0	6,000		

MAKE USE OF COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT MEETINGS

22. Community meetings	No of Physical Meetings held	Twice a Year	2	2	30,000		Chirundu Town Council and WDC
23. Popular theatre (Drama)	No of Popular (Drama) Performances conducted	Quarterly	4	4	40,000		Chirundu Town Council and WDC
24. Public	No of Public	As and when	4	4	8,000		Chirundu



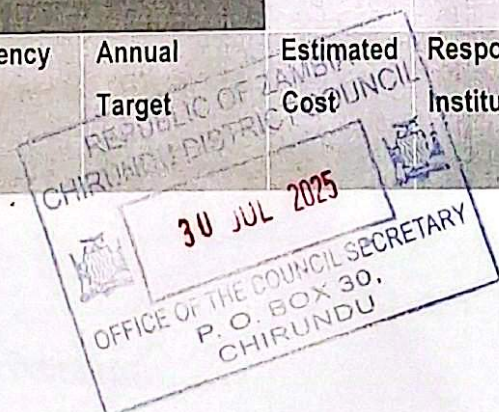
	Announcements	announcements conducted						Town Council
	25. Send Bulk Messages	No of Bulk Messages Sent.	Once a Year (Annually	1	1	10,000		Chirundu Town Council

TOTAL ESTIMATED COST							781,544	
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Objective	Measure/strategy	Activities	Indicators	Frequency	Annual Targets		Estimated Costs	Responsible Institution
					2025	2026		
Promote transparency and accountability		Newsletter production	Number of newsletters produced	Bi Annual	2	2	60,000	Chirundu Town Council
		Conduct Surveys with employees and community members	Number of surveys undertaken	Once per year	1	1	20,000	Chirundu Town Council

TOTAL ESTIMATED COSTS							80,000	
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Objective	Measure	Activity	Indicator	Frequency	Annual Target	Estimated Cost	Responsible Institution
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					2025	2026		
strengthen collaboration with stakeholders	Establish collaborative partnerships with stakeholders	Conduct Stakeholder engagement meetings	Number of stakeholder meetings	1 per quarter	4	4	12, 000	Chirundu Town Council
TOTAL ESTIMATED COSTS							12, 000	
ESTIMATED GRAND COST							873, 544	

7. Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

The MER framework is a structural approach that continually tracks the implementation of the CES, ensures that feedback from the Citizen Engagement inform on going improvements and measures progress towards the set objectives.

Findings from MER will feed into annual reviews, ensuring that lessons learned directly inform adjustments in subsequent Citizen Engagement Plans. This creates a continuous learning loop for stronger inclusivity, accountability, and transparency

8. Conclusion

The Citizen Engagement Strategy (CES) shows the Council's commitment to improving how citizens take part in democratic processes and the management of public resources. It organizes what used to be scattered participation efforts into a coordinated system that gives all community members including women, youth, persons with disabilities, and other marginalized groups real opportunities to engage in budgeting, project planning, and monitoring.

By promoting inclusiveness, transparency, and accountability, and by providing clear ways for citizens to communicate with the Council, the Strategy aims to strengthen public trust, improve governance, and ensure that resources is used wisely to address the community's needs and priorities.

REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA
CHIRUNDU DISTRICT COUNCIL
30 JUL 2025
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